that once felt threatening.

"Some women told me that men no longer intimidated them—instead, the men felt intimidated," Kunnath shares. "These stories of resistance, pride and resilience made the project even more layered."

Kunnath's long-term engagement has allowed the work to evolve beyond portraiture. "I began photographing their homes, the landscapes around them...," she explains. "Those elements added new layers, showing them not just as athletes, but as women, mothers, community members."

The project has expanded Kunnath's role beyond that of a documentarian. She has offered financial support and is now seeking sponsorships to aid her subjects' careers. "That wasn't something I planned at the start," she says. "But the long-term approach has opened my eyes to broader questions about sports in India, about how even the act of pursuing what you love can itself be a privilege."

Not What You Saw arrives at a moment when global conversations around gender in sport are intensifying. Kunnath's work contributes to this dialogue. "We've been conditioned—through cinema, literature, tradition—to accept very narrow ideas of femininity," she says. "These women push back against that."

The reception has been overwhelming. "It has been moving to hear people say that it disrupted their assumptions of what an 'Indian woman' looks like," says Kunnath.

In *Not What You Saw*, Kunnath amplifies underrepresented narratives, urging us to rethink who gets to embody strength and redefine femininity. ■

—Nikhil Sardana

Mapping Mapusa Love

A mural in the heart of the Goan town awaits completion through crowdfunding

A vibrant town in Goa. A 100-metre wall waiting like a blank canvas. An inspired artistic vision. 'Mapusa Mogi' (meaning 'Mapusa lover'), the brainchild of artist Orijit Sen, is a magnificent mural in the making by Sen and other artists. One that celebrates the bustling trade town of Mapusa in myriad materials and techniques. The mega-mural opposite St Jerome's Church awaits new Mapusa lovers to help complete it. Phase one—they call it 'The Centrepiece'—was unveiled in December 2024. A crowdfunding campaign in August raised $30,000 (Rs 26.45 lakh) in 72 hours, which will allow another 30 metres to be painted in 6-8 months.

Sen, the son of a cartographer, fell in love with Mapusa and moved there in 1998. He's the OG Mapusa Mogi who waxes lyrical about varied aspects of the town. "When I first came to Goa, I was struck by the sense of peace and the approach to life, sort of an equilibrium of nature and culture," he says. Over the years, he fell in love with Mapusa and its people, languages, food and experiences. He struck a close friendship with the environmental and social activist couple Norma and Claude Alvares, who helped obtain permissions for the mural. It was conversations around Sen's art installation at the Serendipity Arts Festival in 2016 that sparked the idea. That was an interactive map with clues that engaged the audience. 'Mapusa Mogi' is also a map in a way, perhaps a subliminal paean to the influence of his dad. "I've evolved a visual language for this mural. It's like an illustrated map of the city, but it kind of ignores conventions like perspective and orientation," says Sen. The blueprint is done, but the drawing is constantly evolving as each new artist brings a fresh perspective to this exuberant expression. Sen has been trying to find talented artists in and around Mapusa so that they bring their knowledge of the place.

For the viewer, there are surprises as Sen seeks to explore the interplay between the familiar and the unfamiliar. He has painted some streets in great detail, and there are bits that portray important figures from Mapusa's past, and where he juxtaposes possible futures. Having talked with local kids about their dreams for Mapusa, Sen has incorporated some of their ideas. "Instead of that crowded street full of parked cars, it's a cycling path. Or, a solar-powered tram going down the street!" There are also subtle commentaries on things that need improvement by drawing solutions, such as portraying empty shopping arcades as possible night shelters for migrant labourers. ■

—Priya Pathiyan



ARTIST IN RESIDENCE
Orijit Sen before a section of the 'Mapusa Mogi' mural